

Fetal Kick Counts

Monitoring your baby's movements in the third trimester

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WHY KICK COUNTS MATTER

Once you reach the third trimester, counting your baby's movements is one of the easiest and most effective ways to monitor your baby's wellbeing — and it's free and can be done at home.

Kick counts help you get to know your baby's normal activity patterns so you can quickly recognize when something feels different. A significant change in movement — more or less than usual — can sometimes be a sign that your baby needs attention. Staying in tune with those movements is one of the best things you can do to keep your baby safe.

HOW TO DO KICK COUNTS

Step 1: Eat a meal or snack — babies are most active after you eat.

Step 2: Lie on your side in a comfortable position. Place your hand on your belly.

Step 3: Begin counting every movement you feel — kicks, rolls, jabs, and flutters all count.

Step 4: Stop when you reach **10 movements**. Most babies reach 10 within an hour.

■ If you have not felt 10 movements within 2 hours, call our office right away at (281) 557-0300 so we can do further testing.

WHEN & TIPS

Best times to count:

- After meals — when baby tends to be most active
- In the evening
- After drinking something sweet (juice, milk)

Helpful tips:

- Count at roughly the same time each day to learn your baby's patterns
- Lying on your **left side** increases blood flow and encourages movement
- In late pregnancy, babies have less room — you may feel more rolls and shoulder shifts than kicks. **These all count**
- Use a simple notepad, the clock on your phone, or a free kick count app

■ Getting in tune with your baby's movements is not just reassuring — it's a wonderful way to start bonding before birth.

QUICK REFERENCE

Pick a time daily after a meal	Lie on your side	Count to 10 movements	Goal: 10 in 2 hours	Fewer than 10? Call us
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